Zaid Arsalan Salahuddin

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EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Science, Minor in Astronomy, GPA: 3.60 **May 2028**
Virginia Polytechnic Institute and State University Blacksburg, VA

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming | Java, Python, C
Data Science | Pandas, Matplotlib, Scikit-learn, TensorFlow, Beautiful Soup, Playwright
Web | JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Bootstrap 5, JSON
Tools | VS Code, Jupyter Notebook, Microsoft Office, Git/GitHub, Windows 10/11, Linux

PROJECTS

Class Availability Tracker | Web Scraping ***Jul 2025 – Aug 2025***

- Built a Python-based Discord bot to capture, store, and retrieve structured data on open class seats
- Implemented persistent data storage using JSON to maintain user preferences across restarts
- Improved reliability through input validation, error handling, and user-focused system design

Machine Learning Research (IB Extended Essay) | Reinforcement Learning ***Jun 2023 – Mar 2024***

- Designed and evaluated reinforcement learning models to play Atari Space Invaders
- Implemented training and experimentation pipelines using Python, TensorFlow, and OpenAI Gym
- Authored a 4,000-word research report comparing model performance and experimental results

Data Analysis on Text Messages | Data Processing and Visualization ***Apr 2023 – Aug 2023***

- Developed a program using Python to get statistics on SMS messages
- Cleaned, structured, and analyzed raw text data using Pandas
- Visualized patterns and insights using Matplotlib and Scikit-learn

Eagle Scout Project | Leadership, Project Management, Fundraising ***Oct 2023 – Nov 2023***

- Planned and executed the construction of picnic tables at a local school with 90+ volunteer hours
- Fundraised over $800 through community outreach and social media engagement
- Coordinated and led 10+ volunteers to deliver the project on schedule

EXPERIENCE

inspireFly CubeSat Design Team | Programming Sub-team ***Feb 2026 – Present***

- Developed drivers in micro-python and C for microcontroller-based satellite subsystems
- Interfaced with onboard hardware components using protocols such as SPI and CAN

Virginia Tech Dining Services | Student Worker ***Nov 2025 – Present***

- Worked in a fast-paced café environment while adhering to food safety and operational standards
- Collaborated with team members to support daily dining operations and peak service periods
- Managed item restocking and station cleanliness to fulfill orders during busy periods

Shake Shack | Team Member ***Jun 2026 – Aug 2026***

- Communicated with team members to fulfill orders across multiple stations in a timely manner
- Operated a point-of-service system to process customer orders and payments
- Provided hospitality to guests to ensure a positive dining experience and to resolve customer concerns